Part 1

Building basic generative AI web apps

Generative AI is changing how we build software, and its integration into web applications is opening up incredible new possibilities. You see it everywhere, from chatbots like ChatGPT to the Gemini web interface. These applications use natural language to interact with powerful models, providing accurate, contextual responses. But what's happening under the hood? This book is your guide to building these cutting-edge experiences, and in this first part, we'll cover the essential groundwork.

We'll start with the basics: what generative AI web apps are, how they function, and the unique advantages they offer. From there, we'll get practical, walking you through the initial setup and configuration to build these applications using React and Next.js. You'll also be introduced to the Vercel AI SDK, a crucial tool that simplifies integrating AI models into your projects. Finally, we'll share strategies for effectively scaling and managing state. By the end of these chapters, you'll have a strong grasp of the fundamentals and be ready to begin your journey into full-stack generative AI development.